

# ⚡ RAPID DOWNLOAD #9: LOADOUT

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Read this the first time the PCs are getting ready for a job:

Before you set out on a job, you get to pack some useful gear. This equipment comes from your **loadout theme**, which holds power tags that represent tools, weapons, ammo and everything else that is available to you.

All **loadout tags start out burnt**. Before every job, when I (the MC) say it's time to **Load Up**, you may spend 1 Power to recover any of your loadout tags at the cost of 1 Power per tag (you can later increase this Loading Up Power). You can then use these tags throughout the job like any other power tag. Once the job ends, I say we **Load Off**, and burn all remaining loadout tags.

Choose the tags that seem most useful for the coming job. Your loadout tags aren't necessarily the only items you take with you, but they're the most important. Think of it like in a movie, where we see the protagonist select a few items as they gear up – obviously they take a few more items as well, but those are less important.

When loading up, you can also choose to spend 2 Power to gain a **wildcard loadout tag**, which is like an empty equipment slot, waiting to be filled up. You can then choose one of your loadout tags to activate *during the job*, and we say your PC, being a pro, packed it ahead of time.



A PC's gear can be described by different tags. Power tags that describe equipment represent gear that is at the core of the character, so they somehow always keep it at hand. Story tags can represent makeshift or temporary gear, or items the character acquired for a specific purpose and might not use again.

In addition to those, every PC has a **loadout theme**, a fifth theme beyond their core four themes. The **loadout tags** in this theme represent the resources the PC has access to but doesn't keep on themselves at all times: items in storage, weapons that can be borrowed from allies, access that can be especially requested or bought through a channel the PC has opened in the past, etc.

Loadout tags are power tags, but they are burnt by default. They must be **Loaded Up** as explained below in order to become available, at which point they can be used like every other power tag: they can be burned for Power (page 122), burned by Consequences, recovered with **Restore**, etc.

Tags on the loadout theme that weren't loaded up do not affect gameplay. They might still represent physical items in your possession, but those are either not immediately available, or require some maintenance, ammo, or permission before using that you don't immediately have.

The loadout theme cannot be replaced or lost, and it can't Decay – but it can be upgraded (see the next section).

### LOADOUT TAG SETS

Multiple loadout tags can be used to describe specific features that make a piece of gear more useful in narrow situations. For example, a *sniper rifle* can have *telescopic thermal sight*, *high-caliber rounds*, and *gyro stabilizers*. When firing at an armored target on a windy night (in other words, when this gun is used in the specific conditions it's ideal for), this gun can add up to +4 to Power, invoking all four tags.

### LOADOUT WEAKNESS TAGS & THEME UPGRADES

Whenever a new loadout tag or a set of tags that represent an item are added to a player's loadout theme, the player or MC may add one weakness tag to that item to represent the flaws of that piece of equipment.

A loadout weakness tag can be invoked by the player or the MC, reducing the Power of an affected action by 1, as normal – and the player gets to mark an upgrade box on their loadout theme. When the loadout theme upgrade track is full, the theme gains an upgrade and the track is reset. See **Loadout Theme Upgrades** (page 134).

## LOADING UP

At the end of downtime or before going out to a new job, the MC may declare a **Loading Up** moment:

### LOADING UP POWER

Each player gains **1 Power** to spend on loading up tags from their loadout theme.

This base Loading Up Power can be increased with Loadout Theme Upgrades, by using some Power gained from downtime (page 124), or by invoking directly relevant power tags. Power tags that directly help with packing and carrying items can add to a PC's Loading Up Power, adding 1 Power per tag. This may include power tags such as *carrying capacity*, *preparedness*, *toolbelt*, or *tons of RAM*. At the MC's discretion, weakness tags (such as *physically weak* or *heavy ammunition*) can reduce the PC's Loading Up Power by 1 Power each, but each time this occurs, the PC marks an upgrade box as usual on that weakness tag's theme.

### CHOOSING LOADOUT TAGS

Players then spend this Power to **recover (unburn) their chosen loadout tag(s) at the cost of 1 Power per tag**. If an item has a set of tags representing it, each tag must be loaded up separately and the first tag must be loaded up before any other tags describing features of that item. Mark the loaded up tags by unchecking their burnt checkbox on the loadout theme card.

**As always, Loading Up is also limited by the situation and narrative conditions.** If a PC has regular access to the loadout tag *booster drug* in the Megacity, but they are now Loading Up in the middle of the wilderness, they may not be able to load up that specific loadout tag.

### WILDCARD LOADOUT TAGS

When Loading Up, a player may also choose to spend Power on **wildcard loadout tags**. These are unspecified "tag slots" that can be used to load up any tag from the PC's loadout theme at any time during the job, revealing new gear that the PC has packed in advance. This represents a character who is prepared for the situation at hand, even if the player did not yet know what gear was needed. The downside to this freedom is a cost of 2 Power per tag. Once a wildcard loadout tag was used to load up a specific loadout tag, it cannot be changed.

## SHARING GEAR

During downtime, players can have their characters exchange items on their loadout themes, provided they represent items that can be given and would still operate in the same manner, that is, are not customized or tailored to the original owner.

Similarly, during a job, a PC can pass their active loadout tags to another PC, with the same caveat. If passing the item between the PCs is uncertain and dramatic, the MC may ask the player to take action to determine if it can be done (usually resolved as a quick outcome).

## CATALOGS

Catalogs are premade lists of loadout tags you can pick from to add to your loadout theme. The **Street Catalog** (page 252) lists commonly available items in the Megacity that PCs could usually obtain by taking an action.

**Loot catalogs** are lists of items the PCs find, such as a stash or a database, and are usually a reward for a successful job. You can find an example of a loot catalog in the starter job, *Strings Attached* (page 351).

## LIMITED ACCESS

Different characters may have access to different kinds of loadout tags, even from the **Street Catalog** (page 252), depending on their themes and background: a street kid with few material resources might have better access to illegal weapons than to fancy accommodations.

The MC should also consider limiting access to specific items or even categories of items, depending on the character and the situation – a PC's ability to obtain access is impacted by the nature of the cinematic moment, where it takes place, how long they have, who they know, which tools they have, and the conditions they are under.

## LOADING OFF

At the beginning of downtime or the end of the job, the MC may declare a Loading Off moment. All loaded up tags in the loadout theme are then burnt, including unused wildcard loadout tags. This is not to say the gear disappears, but it does mean it needs additional care to continue being useful or important. If the player wants to retain the same active tags for the next job, they must load up the same tags again on their next Loading Up moment.

## ADDING TAGS TO THE LOADOUT THEME

All PCs **start the game with three loadout tags** in their loadout theme. During play, new tags can be added to the loadout theme in the following ways.

### LOOT

During a job, and especially when it ends, the PCs might acquire new resources as payment, reward, loot, salvage, or otherwise. These resources often come in the form of a **loot catalog**, a list of tags representing items. The players can then choose to add these to their loadout themes. Each item in the loot catalog – a single tag or a set of tags – can be copied to **one** PC's loadout theme, with exceptions at the MC's discretion. Loadout tags added in this way are burnt and must be Loaded Up (or **Restored**, during a job) to be ready for action, unless the MC rules otherwise.

### BUYING, CRAFTING & HIRING

Creating loadout tags follows the same rules as creating story tags. A player who wants to create new loadout tags for their character can take action during a job or during downtime to **Create** tags at the cost of 2 Power per loadout tag.

Loadout tags created in this way are not burnt and can be used immediately, but during the next Loading Off moment they are automatically burnt along with all the rest of the PC's loadout tags.

As always, the loadout tags added to the loadout theme in this way must match the narration of the action and the tags activated in the procurement action; a PC cannot gain the loadout tag *assault rifle* by being a *pharmacist*.

- **Buy It:** A PC can purchase items using power tags that indicate appropriate access to vendors such as *cheap Source peddler*, *cybermarket trader*, or *drug dealer* as well as tags and statuses representing money and skill at trading. This can be used to acquire items from the **Street Catalog** or any item that the PC's power tags conceivably grant access to. See also **Making a Purchase** in the supplement *:Otherscape Action Database*.
- **Workshop and Practice:** A PC can make new items using power tags that indicate their craft such as *robotics*, *weaponsmith*, or *alchemist*. They can also invest time and effort in analysis or practice, such as researching new spells for the spellbook or training with martial art techniques, which later will need to be recalled when Loading Up. See also **Finding and Focusing on a Specific Ability** and **Building, Crafting, or Upgrading Tech** in the supplement *:Otherscape Action Database*.

- **Recruiting and Hiring:** A PC can call on connections or favors with experts, hire professionals to join them in the field, or recruit minions or lackeys, using power tags such as *mercenary network*, *feared in the clan*, or *rousing rhetoric*. See also **Gathering Support and Resources** in the supplement *:Otherscape Action Database*.

### KEEPING STORY TAGS

During play, the players acquire helpful story tags representing people, places, and objects that they might want to keep for later. While some of them represent temporary items that may expire, others might remain available after the job is over, or represent things that the PCs can reasonably take with them and keep for later.

A player may keep any story tag their PC possesses – such as a tag that was previously **Created**, given by the MC, or generated through a Special – and record it as a loadout tag in their loadout theme. The story tag becomes an unburnt loadout tag that the player can continue using as before, and on the next Loading Off moment it is automatically burnt along with all other loadout tags.

This option should be used only for tags that reasonably represent a reliable resource that can be Loaded Up over and over again in the future, and the MC can always overrule it. A reluctant district guide coerced at gunpoint to help the crew navigate a dangerous area will probably not remain available after the job is over; however, a friendly guide hired to do their job and finishing it in one piece will probably be happy to help the PCs again.

If the story tag isn't reasonably suitable for becoming a loadout tag, the MC could deny it altogether or ask the player to take action to **Create** the loadout tag, as under **Buying, Crafting & Hiring** above.

### REMOVING TAGS FROM THE LOADOUT THEME

A player may choose to remove any loadout tag from their loadout theme, indicating the PC no longer has easy access to that item or resource.

The MC may remove loadout tags if a player gained a relevant tier-6 (transformative) status, such as *broken-6* or *alienated-6*, or if their warehouse got *burned-down-6*.

### OPTIONAL RULE: REMOVING LOADOUT TAGS AS A CONSEQUENCE

With this rule, the MC can use Consequences to remove any number of loadout tags from a PC's loadout theme. This could happen in the following situations:

- **An item is destroyed or stolen.** If the PC only has one copy of an item with a loadout tag and that item is stolen, confiscated, taken, or irreparably damaged, it may be removed from the loadout theme. This can happen in conjunction with a Consequence that burns the tag. For example, a vehicle hotwiring device may need to be recharged or rewired every now and then, but an especially bad zap from a vehicle security system can destroy it entirely, forcing the PC to acquire a new one.
- **Access is revoked:** If the PC breaks ties with some of their contacts or allies (or if they are no longer available), any item or service that the PC could regularly ask from them becomes unavailable and removed from the loadout theme

